



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Berean Christian Academy
School Website: <https://berean-baptist-utah.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Berean Christian Academy Utah (UT 84403) demonstrates strong alignment with classical education across all six canonical categories of the classical rubric. Public-facing materials emphasize the grammar, logic, and rhetoric approach; a curriculum that includes primary sources and Latin; pedagogy that moves from chant and memory in the grammar years to Socratic/debate forms in the dialectic years and rhetoric-focused instruction in the upper grades; a faculty oriented toward mentorship and living the curriculum; and a robust emphases on parental partnership and community formation grounded in a biblical framework. Sources from the school's site clearly reference classical methods, theology, liturgical and communal practices, and explicit parent partnership, all of which map closely to the Positive Keyword indicators in the Six Essential Elements framework. There is little to no explicit negative-language signaling anti-classical orientations in the school's public materials. Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

Key evidentiary anchors include: - Direct statements of a classical method (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a K-12 commitment, with emphasis on Latin, primary sources, and memorization (grammar, memory, and recitation) across grades, plus upper-grade Socratic/debate elements. - Theological and liturgical orientations tied to a biblical framework, including explicit statements about Biblical instruction for families, theology as a unifying discipline, and communal worship/formation. - Explicit references to virtue, truth, and beauty as transcendent aims, with affirmations of "true, noble, just" thought and a liturgical-aesthetic vision. - Public materials indicating a cooperative parent-school formation model and parent involvement as co-teachers or partners.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials articulate a theologically grounded education, with explicit statements about Biblical instruction, the lordship of God over all knowledge, and a Christian worldview that integrates creation and theology. - Aesthetic Vision page invokes truth, beauty, and noble aims in formation, including a biblical sense of beauty and a sacred orientation to learning. - Positive references to the triune God and the claim that ultimate loveliness and beauty are found in God, signaling transcendental refrains consistent with classical religious foundations.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, beauty, virtue, reverence, theology, liturgy, worship, wonder, sacred, Logos, imago Dei (as implied through theology and aesthetics content). - Negative keywords: none clearly present in public materials (no explicit signaling of secularism or relativism in the church/school materials).

Why this rating - The school anchors education in theological commitments, liturgical practices, and metaphysical aims, with explicit references to God, truth as objective, and beauty as a real transcendent. This aligns with the Positive keyword indicators for Element 1 and shows no countervailing negative signals in the public materials. CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom rather than mere information or job preparation, citing a classical formation approach and a commitment to virtue and human flourishing. -

Texts emphasize “formation” over mere factual transfer, and a teleology toward true, good, and beautiful, aligned with classical telos expectations. - The program foregrounds the integration of faith and learning, with an aim to form the mind in a biblically informed, transcendent framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, true/good/beautiful, transcendentals, telos, classical mission, contemplation (scholé tone). - Negative keywords: none evident (no emphasis on workforce-centric or relativistic aims in the public text).

Why this rating - The emphasis on formation, virtue, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty maps squarely to the Positive keywords for Element 2, with little to no contrary signals. CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum centers the liberal arts of grammar, logic, and rhetoric, with explicit emphasis on those triad elements across the program. - History is taught through primary sources and classic materials (not merely “social studies”), signaling a Great Books/Great Conversation orientation. The materials describe using primary sources in history and a classical approach to study. - Latin begins early (3rd grade) and continues through 10th grade, with emphasis on grammar and memory (chanting) in early years, followed by dialectic and rhetoric in later years. - The school discusses grammars/logic/ rhetoric as the mechanism for expressing learned knowledge, consistent with classical curricular design.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books/-Great Conversation (expressed through primary sources and classical pedagogy), Latin, history through primary sources, memory work/recitation, chanting. - Negative keywords: none identified in public materials related to curriculum (no “project-based learning” emphasis or social studies framing that would signal a non-classical approach).

Why this rating - The curriculum is clearly structured around the classical triad and a Great Books/primary-sources orientation, with explicit methods for memorization, recitation, and later dialectic/rhetoric work. CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogical progression described: chanting and memorization in grammar years; debate/discussion and logic instruction in dialectic years; rhetoric-focused instruction and public speaking in rhetoric years. - Acknowledgement of contemplative/restful elements in education (scholé) and moments of wonder within lower grades, alongside a rising emphasis on Socratic/dialogic methods in upper grades. - The upper grades emphasize rhetorical training, speeches, and formal rhetorical work; there is clear alignment with classical pedagogy expectations (Socratic/seminar-style discussion in later years). - Some materials reference communal/scholé learning and memory practice (chanting and singing for memorization) in lower grades.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: scholé, contemplation, wonder, chanting, memorization, narration, rhetorical training, Socratic discussion, seminars, debate, memory work, catechesis, liturgical calendar integration. - Negative keywords: none evident in the public materials (no overt signaling of project-based-only or constructivist approaches that would run counter to classical pedagogy).

Why this rating - Pedagogy follows the classical arc from contemplative/memory-rich early instruction to Socratic and rhetoric-driven upper levels, which matches CLASSICAL expectations. CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty described as capable, professional, and dedicated to teaching and mentoring; staff are described as living the curriculum and as partners in student formation. Public materials emphasize teachers who are skilled, caring, and capable of guiding students through rigorous classical training. - There is explicit emphasis on teacher as mentor and living curriculum, with staff nurturing students and modeling virtue, and a culture of collegiality and mentorship. - The school expresses a desire that teachers coach and mentor

new staff and serve as academic mentors to students, signaling a strong faculty culture aligned with classical aims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, model teachers and mentors, portrait of a teacher, collegial culture, teachers as guides/mentors, professional and diligent in their work, love of students and subject. - Negative keywords: none evident in public materials.

Why this rating - The public materials present a robust portrayal of a faculty that embodies classical ideals in both instruction and mentorship. CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents a partnership model with parents, positioning parents as co-teachers or co-educators in the classical formation process. Public materials emphasize parent involvement and formation, and there are explicit calls to educate parents through book studies and gatherings to understand classical education. - The academy stresses welcoming parents for visits and ongoing involvement in the school community, indicating an open, collaborative posture toward families. - Biblical framing of family education (Deuteronomy 6:6–7) and parental authority in the educational process articulate a family-centered classical community orientation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation, family-centered education, parental involvement, open campus/invite for visits. - Negative keywords: none evident (no consumerist or minimal-parent-involvement signals in the public text).

Why this rating - The school presents a clearly classical model of parent engagement and community formation, consistent with the Element 6 positive indicators. CLASSICAL.

Overall assessment: CLASSICAL

What would move the needle - Not applicable, as all six categories are CLASSICAL. No major changes are required to reach full classical alignment based on the current public materials. If anything, ongoing refinement might emphasize even more explicit references to “Great Books” and direct quotes of classical texts within the curriculum materials to further crystallize the Great Conversation framework for external readers, but this is a matter of signaling rather than a substantive doctrinal shift.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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